

Backroom Bookings — Manager SOP

For Camille, Nheaca, and anyone else running the bookings portal day-to-day. Replaces the old spreadsheet workflow.

If something here doesn't match what you're seeing in the app, ping Soraya — the system is still being polished.

Quick start: the 6 things you'll do most

1. **Triage a new inquiry** → `/bookings`, click into the row, Confirm or Cancel.
2. **Quick Hold a date** that someone texted you about → big "Quick Hold" button at top of `/bookings`.
3. **Send a band their portal link** if they didn't get the auto email → on the booking detail page, "Send portal link" action.
4. **Mark a fee as paid** when cash hits the till → on the booking detail page, "Mark venue fee paid" / "Mark door fee paid".
5. **Publish to Squarespace** → on a confirmed booking, click **Copy formatted (paste into Text Block)** in the Squarespace Listing card, then paste into a Squarespace Text Block. Set the listing-status dropdown to match.
6. **Acknowledge band-side changes** → when an amber/pink banner appears at the top of a booking ("Times changed" or "Ticket info changed"), mirror the change to Squarespace and click **Acknowledge** to clear the alert.

Everything else is bonus.

The dashboard at a glance

`/bookings` shows six tiles at the top. Each is a clickable filter.

Tile	What it counts	When to look
Inquiries to review	New form submissions waiting for you	First thing each morning
Holds	Soft-reserved dates that haven't converted yet	Weekly — chase or release
Tentative	Bookings on hold pending more info	Weekly
Confirmed upcoming	Locked-in future gigs	Reference
Outstanding fees	Confirmed/completed gigs with venue or door fee unpaid	End of week
Not on Squarespace	Confirmed gigs not yet listed on the website	Weekly publishing
Listing info pending	Listed on Squarespace but waiting for info (ticket link, poster, etc.)	Weekly publishing
Door person TBC (≤7 days)	Confirmed gigs in the next week with no door person assigned	Daily check

(Tile counts exclude archived rows.)

Workflow: inquiry → confirmed

When a band submits the form

1. Inquiry lands at `/bookings` with status **Inquiry** (orange badge)
2. Click into it from the bookings list
3. Read through: - Act + event date + day of week - Contact info - Bio / promo text - Ticket price + link (if any) - Support act, door person request - "Recent emails" panel — has there been any back-and-forth via email already?
4. Decide: - **Confirm Booking** → fires the approval email (band + Shane CC'd), generates a €50 door-fee Square link if applicable, and creates the Google Calendar event - **Confirm (silent — no emails)** → same as above but skips the email + Square link. Useful for re-confirms, internal admin fixes, or bookings where you've already coordinated with the band by phone/email - **Tentative** → mark Tentative if you want to soft-hold while you check something - **Cancel + Email Decline** → sends the "date now taken" decline email with a "Pick another date" link, then archives - **Cancel** (silent) → cancels without sending any email - **Archive** → if it's spam or clearly not a fit, archive it (it drops out of all your lists)

Editing a confirmed booking

When you edit a booking that's already confirmed (door time, contact details, support act, notes — anything), the **Google Calendar event auto-refreshes** with the new info on save. No need to manually update the calendar. If you change a confirmed booking back to tentative/hold/inquiry, the calendar event is automatically deleted so the calendar doesn't show a confirmed-looking event for something that isn't.

What the confirmation email does

- Sends to the band with full gig details, venue/door fees, ticketing recommendations, Shane's contact, and a portal link
- **CCs Shane** so he's looped in for sound coordination
- Attaches an `.ics` calendar invite the band can add to their own calendar
- Stamps `confirmation_sent_at` and adds a Google Calendar event

After confirmation

The booking auto-progresses through these markers as work gets done:

- Band uploads their poster via the portal → shows on detail page
- 2 weeks before: a checklist email goes out (door person ask, poster upload reminder, pay-in-advance link)
- 3 days before: countdown reminder
- After the gig: status moves to Completed (manually or via cron)

Quick Hold — soft-reserving a date

When someone texts/calls and says "can I have May 23rd?" but they haven't filled in the form yet:

1. On `/bookings`, click the **Quick Hold** button (top right, between Calendar View and Add Booking)
2. Fill in: - **Held for** — the band/person's name (required) - **Date** (required) - Email + phone (optional) - Notes (optional — e.g. "Texted via WhatsApp, will confirm next week")
3. Submit → creates a booking with status **Hold** (purple badge)

The hold: - Marks the date as **tentative on the public form** — bands using `/book` won't see it as bookable - Shows on your internal calendar in **purple** - Counts on the **Holds** tile - Doesn't trigger any email to the band

When the band confirms, open the hold → change status to **Confirmed** → fill in the missing details → Approve. The hold becomes a real booking and triggers the confirmation

email.

If the hold expires (band ghosted), open it → Cancel or Archive.

Calendar conventions

Open `bookings@cobblestonepub.ie` Google Calendar (subscribe in your own Google account if you haven't already).

Color	What
 Sage green	Form-backed bookings — band has submitted info
 Default yellow	Calendar-only — Tomás added manually, no form info yet
 Lavender	Upstairs / workshop events
 Graphite	Bar / non-Backroom (table holds, filming)

The internal app calendar (`/bookings/calendar`) uses different colors based on **status**, not provenance: - Green = confirmed - Yellow/orange = inquiry/tentative - Purple = hold - Grey = completed - Light grey = cancelled

Common tasks

Send a band their portal link manually

If a band says "I didn't get an email":

1. Open `/bookings/<id>`
2. Verify their email address is right
3. Click **Send portal link** in the actions sidebar
4. Tell them to check spam if it doesn't show within a minute

Mark venue fee or door fee as paid

On the booking detail: - **Mark venue fee paid** button (when €150 lands) - **Mark door fee paid** button (when €50 lands or door takings settle)

These flip the row out of the "Outstanding fees" KPI tile.

Publish a gig to Squarespace

When a gig is confirmed and ready to go on the website:

1. Open the booking. Scroll to the **Squarespace Listing** card (only appears on confirmed bookings that aren't marked internal-only — see "Internal-only events" below).
2. The card shows a live preview of how the listing will render (H2 act name, H3 support act, description paragraphs, links, bold Doors / Gig / Ticket lines).
3. Click **Copy formatted (paste into Text Block)**. This writes rich-text HTML to your clipboard.
4. In Squarespace, add a **Text Block** to the event page (NOT a Code Block — Text Blocks inherit your site's typography). Paste. The H2 / H3 / bold / links all come through with your existing site styles.
5. If the band gave a video URL in the description, add a separate Squarespace **Video Block** above the text — Text Blocks can't render iframes/embeds. There's an inline reminder in the card when a video URL is detected.
6. Back in the app, set the **Squarespace listing** dropdown in the Fees & Listing card:

State	When
Not listed	Default — gig not yet on Squarespace
Listed — info pending	On the site but missing ticket link / poster / final info
Listed — complete	Fully published, nothing missing

The dropdown saves on change. The two intermediate states each have their own KPI tile so you can chase the gaps weekly without losing track.

There's also a plain-text fallback (collapsible "Plain-text version" section) — only useful if you're pasting into a non-Squarespace destination.

Assign a door person

On the booking detail, the Door Person field has options: - **pub** — Cobblestone provides one, €50 door fee charged. Auto-generates a Square payment link the band can use. - **pub_no_fee** — Cobblestone provides one, no fee (residencies, special arrangements). - **own** — band brings their own. - **tbc** — to be confirmed. - **none** — not needed.

The booking detail page shows a coloured badge at the top of the header so you can see the current arrangement at a glance.

Confirmed gigs within 7 days with no door person set show a yellow **Door person TBC** warning badge on the bookings list.

Confirmed gigs where the **pub** is providing (either **pub** or **pub_no_fee**) show a blue **Doorperson needed** badge on the list — useful for scanning staffing needs across the week.

Send a custom message to the band

On the booking detail, **Send message** action: - Free-text subject + body - Wrapped in the Cobblestone brand template - Useful for one-offs ("can you bring extra mic stands?")

Cancel vs archive

- **Cancel** = the gig isn't happening. Status flips to Cancelled, badge goes black, and the booking is auto-archived. Two flavours:
- **Cancel + Email Decline** → sends the "date now taken" email
- **Cancel** (default) → silent, no email
- **Archive** = hide it from the active list (KPI tiles too). The data is still there — toggle "Show archived" on the bookings list to see them. Use for very old completed gigs, spam inquiries, or test bookings you don't want cluttering the queue.

Cancelling auto-archives. To unarchive (restore to active list), flip on "Show archived" toggle, open the booking, and click **Unarchive**.

Daytime-only / non-blocking events

Some events (e.g. Dublin Jazz Coop's Sunday afternoon sessions, private rehearsals before a show) happen during the day and shouldn't block an evening gig from booking. On the booking detail, tick "**Doesn't block public calendar**" — this keeps the booking on your internal views (it shows on `/bookings`, counts on KPI tiles, appears on the Google Calendar) but the public booking form treats the date as **available**.

To bulk-flag a recurring contact's bookings, use:

```
python3 flag_nonblocking.py --email someone@example.com --confirm
```

Filter persistence

When you filter the bookings list (status, search, date range, view) and click into a booking, the "**Back to bookings**" button remembers the filter and returns you to the same view. Works through any number of edits/status changes inside the detail page.

Residency Gigs — the in-house regulars

For events that happen at the Backroom on a recurring basis and don't follow the normal booking workflow — Balaclavas, Caoimhe's Monday dance class, Larry's Night, Pipers' Club, Dublin Jazz Coop — use the **event_type** "**Residency Gigs**". This gives them:

- A pink badge in the bookings list (so they read at a glance)
- A pink colour on the Google Calendar event
- Light-pink row tinting in the bookings list

- **Drops out of the "Door person TBC" KPI tile** and warning badges — these don't need a door person, so they shouldn't trigger the alert
- A **"Hide residency gigs"** filter on the bookings list — flip this on when you want to focus on actual external gigs

Fees, door person, and other fields stay editable — these are defaults, not locked. Override per-booking if a residency night ever does need fees or a door person.

To create a new residency series: 1. `/bookings/series/new` 2. Pick **Event Type: Residency Gigs** from the dropdown 3. Fill in act name, recurrence pattern, start/end dates 4. Submit — all generated bookings inherit the Residency Gigs tag

Dublin Jazz Coop is special — they happen on Sunday afternoons (3pm-6pm), so they're flagged **non-blocking** on the public form (an evening gig can still book the same Sunday). Each Jazz Coop booking carries a note:

Sunday afternoon residency — room is occupied until 6pm. Any evening soundcheck/load-in on the same date must be after 6pm. Shane handles sound. Jazz Coop manage their own door (no door person needed).

When confirming a Sunday-evening booking on a Jazz Coop date, add a note to that booking's description so the band knows about the 6pm load-in cutoff.

What bands can update themselves (via their portal)

Each booking has a band-facing portal at `/book/<token>`. As of May 2026 the band can update three things post-confirmation:

Field	Why it matters
Description	Bio / lineup / blurb for the public listing
Door + gig (start) times	Set times can shift after confirmation — they often don't have them locked when they request the date
Ticket info — type, price, link	Bands often don't have the Eventbrite URL or final price at the moment they request the date

What they **can't** change: the event date, the venue, the contact details, or anything financial. Date changes still come through us.

All band-side edits write to `booking_audit` (visible at the bottom of the booking detail page) so there's always a record.

Acknowledging band-side changes

When a band updates their times or ticket info, an alert surfaces in two places on your side:

- A **coloured banner** at the top of the booking detail page showing old → new values.
- A matching **badge** on the row in the bookings list (🕒 Times changed in amber, 🎫 Ticket info changed in pink).

For **time changes** an email also fires to `cobblestonedublin@gmail.com` — these are higher-urgency since the gig is usually imminent.

Workflow when one of these appears:

1. Open the booking from the badge.
2. Read the banner — it shows you the current values inline.
3. Mirror the change to Squarespace (and the Google Calendar event if it's a time change — but the calendar updates automatically for confirmed bookings, so that's already done).
4. Click **Acknowledge** on the banner. Banner + badge clear, audit log records the acknowledgment.

Info sheet & tech spec acknowledgment

The portal's confirmation checklist asks the band to confirm they've read the **Info Sheet** (venue info, load-in details) and **Tech Spec** (PA, monitors, stage layout) PDFs.

Both PDFs stay available on their portal *after* acknowledgment too — previously the buttons disappeared once acked, but bands kept asking for the links so they're now permanently visible. After acking, a small "Acknowledged YYYY-MM-DD" note appears beside the heading and the helper text changes to "always available here, open any time."

You'll see the acked / not-acked status on the booking detail page's checklist column.

Internal-only events

Some events shouldn't appear on Squarespace at all — private hires, rehearsals, filming sessions, mate-of-the-pub one-offs. Tick "**Don't list on website (internal only)**" in the Booking Details form and click **Save Changes**.

What that does: - Hides the Squarespace Listing card (rich-text generator) on the detail page. - Replaces the Squarespace status dropdown with a muted "Internal only" indicator. - Swaps the row badge on `/bookings` to a grey **Internal only** pill instead of one of the pink/orange/teal listing-status badges. - Excludes the booking from the "Not on Squarespace" and "Listing info pending" KPI tile counts.

Untick to bring it back into the listing workflow at any time.

Weekly run sheet (printable)

`/bookings/week-sheet` — printable summary of the week's confirmed gigs for whoever's working the door / FOH.

One card per gig with everything operationally relevant: act + support, doors / gig / end, door person, fee status (paid/unpaid pills), ticketing, band contact + phone, notes. **Prev / This week / Next week** buttons; **Print** button hides the sidebar for clean A4 output. Cards don't split across page breaks.

Quick workflow: print every Monday and stick it behind the bar so the team can glance at it through the week.

Squarespace listing — 3-state dropdown

On the booking detail page, the **Squarespace listing** dropdown has three options:

State	Meaning
Not listed	Default — gig not yet on the website
Listed — info pending	On the site but waiting for info (ticket link, poster, etc.)
Listed — complete	Fully published, nothing missing

KPI tiles match: "Not on Squarespace" + "Listing info pending" both surface bookings that need your attention. Saves on change — no extra click.

Scenarios

Two bands want the same date

The system flags conflicts as **needs review** during import, but when both submit fresh:

1. Open both bookings (same date filter on `/bookings`)
2. Decide who gets the date based on your judgement
3. Confirm the winner → triggers their confirmation email AND auto-declines other inquiries on the same date with the "date now taken" email (which includes a one-click "Pick another date" link)
4. Verify both emails went out

A confirmed band needs to change date

1. Open the booking
2. Edit the event date inline

3. Use **Send custom message** to confirm the new date with them
4. The Google Calendar event updates automatically

Band asks via phone or WhatsApp instead of the form

1. **Quick Hold** the date so it's locked while you sort it
2. Send them the form link via reply: `bookings.cobblestonepub.ie/book` — the canned Gmail reply has the right wording
3. When they submit, convert the hold to confirmed (or merge manually if needed)

Someone emails `cobblestonedublin@gmail.com` (the old inbox)

- That inbox auto-forwards to `bookings@cobblestonepub.ie`
- Reply with the canned Gmail reply pointing them at the form
- For repeat bookers / known acts, you can also Quick Hold the date while they fill the form

A band doesn't show up

- After the gig date passes, status auto-progresses to **Completed** by the daily cron (or you can flip it manually)
- For a no-show specifically, mark **Cancelled** with a note in the notes field for future reference
- Cancelling auto-archives, so it falls out of the active list

A contact has multiple bookings (e.g. residencies)

For acts/promoters with several gigs (Dublin Jazz Coop has 8+ slots, Pipers' Club is monthly, etc.), the system uses one **multi-gig portal** per email address at `/portal/<token>` :

- One link per contact email — shows ALL their upcoming bookings
- Each gig in the list deep-links to its individual `/book/<token>` page (where they upload posters, ack the info sheet, etc.)
- Used by the **portal-intro mailer** so a contact with 8 dates gets ONE email instead of 8 separate ones

If a band lands on a per-booking page (`/book/<token>`) and they have other active bookings under the same email, a blue **"You have N other bookings — View all →"** banner appears at the top so they can jump to the multi-gig view.

To send portal-intro emails to all confirmed bookings 14+ days out:

```
python3 bookings_send_portal_links.py --dry-run    # preview
python3 bookings_send_portal_links.py             # actually send
```

Idempotent — won't double-send to anyone who's already had one.

When to escalate to Soraya

- Anything sounds like an app bug ("the button doesn't work", error messages, missing data)
- A booking shows wrong info that can't be fixed by editing
- Email isn't sending and you've already verified the contact email
- DKIM / spam complaints from bands
- Need to add a new manager to the system
- Need to add a new feature or change a workflow

For day-of-gig technical issues (sound, equipment, etc.) — that's Shane (+353 85 175 8254).

Reference: keyboard shortcuts & URLs

What	Where
Bookings tracker	/bookings
Calendar view	/bookings/calendar
Weekly run sheet (printable)	/bookings/week-sheet
Single booking	/bookings/<id>
Add booking manually	/bookings/new
Quick hold	Modal on /bookings
Recurring series	/bookings/series
Blackout dates	/bookings/blackouts
Band contacts	/bookings/contacts
Public gig form	/book
Public other form	/book/other (filming, rehearsal, private hire)
Band per-booking portal	/book/<token> (one per booking)
Multi-gig contact portal	/portal/<token> (one per email)
Sound engineer view	/sound (Shane's login only)

Production URL: <https://bookings.cobblestonepub.ie> (or <https://cobblestone-pub.onrender.com> if the custom domain isn't fully set up yet).

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